

Elina Mäkinen

MHSc | Health Informatics and Professional Agency

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Health informatics researcher interested in how clinicians keep professional autonomy when digital systems structure their work. My background combines eight years of nursing practice with qualitative field research and survey methods. My doctoral research interest is in when electronic health record design supports clinical judgement and when it pushes clinicians into workarounds.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Professional autonomy and agency in digitally mediated clinical work
- Workarounds as signals of misfit between systems and practice
- Design of electronic health records that supports clinical judgement

DEGREES

Master of Health Sciences, Health Informatics 2022 – 2024

University of Eastern Finland, Kuopio, Finland

Thesis: Workarounds in electronic health record use among hospital nurses.

Bachelor of Health Care, Nursing 2012 – 2016

Tampere University of Applied Sciences, Finland

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Master's thesis research 2023 – 2024

University of Eastern Finland, with a university hospital ward

- Examined why hospital nurses work around electronic health record workflows, framed through professional autonomy.
- Interviewed 24 nurses and analysed the data with thematic analysis.
- Found that workarounds protect professional autonomy, the theme my doctoral interest in clinicians' agency builds on.

RESEARCH OUTPUT

[1] Mäkinen, E. (2024). Workarounds in electronic health record use among hospital nurses [Master's thesis, University of Eastern Finland]. <https://example.org/thesis>

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

Registered Nurse 2016 – present

Example University Hospital, Tampere

- Daily clinical use of the hospital's electronic health record, the practice setting of the planned doctoral research.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Finnish – native | English – C1 | Swedish – B1

RESEARCH METHODS AND TOOLS

Qualitative: Semi-structured interviews, thematic analysis, NVivo

Quantitative: Survey design, descriptive statistics, SPSS